AI Development Residency Week 1 Submission

Links

1. GitHub repository

Documents

1. Notion page

What I Did

Set up computer for coding

- Set my Git identity, cloned the repo, and learned the add → commit→ push → pull loop
- Learned to make folders, add files, and use a .gitkeep placeholder
- Installed Node and Claude Code and confirmed it works

Built skills

- Created four Claude Code skills: commit-msg, secrets-management, a11y-wcag, and input-validation
- Created three Claude desktop skills: learn-dev-concept, architecture-design-doc, and residency-progress-update
- Added a secrets safety net (.gitignore, .env.example) and a CLAUDE.md so that skills can get used every session

Designed the project

- Started fleshing out my project idea, which involves co-designing with community members on an application to evaluate nonprofit effectiveness so that they can use the insights to execute direct public action and collective advocacy

- Asked Claude desktop to help me organize the project around design justice principles
- Asked Claude desktop to help me with a co-design plan, build guide, and a right-sized MVP #1

Worked on the manifesto

- Created a manifesto for the project and will share out for feedback pending tightening of the language and tone as well as adding citations for sector data

Licensed the repo

- Chose and added AGPL-3.0 to keep the code open and community-owned and noted it in the README

What I Learned

- The value of receipts in making sure the skills I add are used consistently and correctly. I will be reviewing the Enterprise Skills for AI Development pdf for tips
- There is a clear difference between consultation and co-design, and it lies in who has the decision-making power to shape the project
- Certain ethical missteps would undermine the basic premise of the project such as
    - Making decisions alone
    - Asking community members for unpaid labor
- I went out on a limb and asked Claude desktop directly about minimizing environmental and cultural impact related to the use of AI in this project. It started to shape some guardrails for responsible use and put together some simple talking points for me to explain to others how AI will and will not be used in the project.